

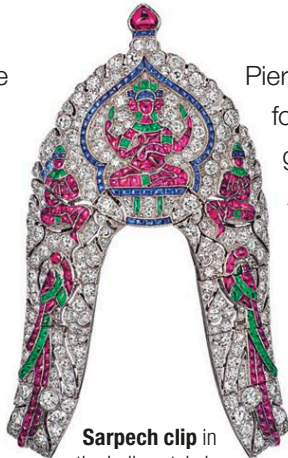


△ **Detail** of a briolette-cut sapphire from the necklace

# Tutti Frutti necklace

This necklace is one of the most spectacular pieces of Indian-inspired jewellery that Cartier produced. Colourful and exotic, the necklace, which the jewellery house designed for the French-American socialite and heiress Daisy Fellowes in 1936, heralded an exciting new look that came to epitomize the glamour and opulence of the Jazz Age. At the time, this style of necklace was known as a *collier hindou* ("Hindu necklace"), but in the 1970s, Cartier rebranded the range "Tutti Frutti" ("All Fruits"), to highlight the resemblance of the colourful cut gems to berries, leaves, and blossoms.

Cartier forged its cultural connection with India in 1901, when Queen Alexandra (wife of King Edward VII) commissioned



**Sarpech clip** in the Indian style by Van Cleef & Arpels

Pierre Cartier to design a necklace for her to complement three Indian gowns that she had been given. A decade later, Cartier's brother Jacques travelled to the Indian subcontinent, partly to witness the coronation of King George V, but also to make contact with several maharajahs, who wanted their own jewels set with Gallic flair.

These Indian pieces created a sensation in the West, with Cartier's clients queuing up for similar items – Daisy Fellowes's necklace was loosely based on one that Cartier had designed for the Maharajah of Patna. Daisy was famed in society circles at the time, with gossip columnists lingering over details of her scandalous affairs and extravagant lifestyle, but she was also admired as a genuine fashion icon. For her *collier hindou*, Cartier recycled 785 gems from a necklace and two bracelets that she already owned, and added a further 238 diamonds and eight rubies. Completed in 1936, the necklace was a resounding triumph.

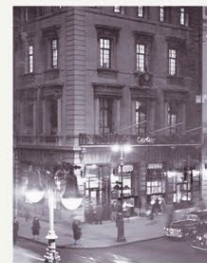


**Daisy Fellowes** wearing the Tutti Frutti necklace at a celebrated costume ball in Venice in 1951, where she masqueraded as the "Queen of Africa"

## Key dates

### 1800s–1990

- 1901 Pierre Cartier produces his first Indian-inspired necklace
- 1900
- 1911 Jacques Cartier makes his initial trip to India
- 1936 Cartier completes Daisy Fellowes's necklace
- 1950
- 1937 Photographs of Fellowes wearing the necklace appear in *Vogue*
- 1951 Fellowes wears the necklace at a magnificent costume ball in Venice
- 1960
- 1962 Fellowes' daughter inherits the necklace and makes alterations to it
- 1970
- 1970 Cartier coin the term "Tutti Frutti" to describe their Indian-style jewellery
- 2000
- 1990 The necklace is auctioned in Geneva; Cartier purchases it for a record price of \$2,655,172



Cartier's New York shop, photographed by Alfred Eisenstaedt

## Jewelry that gleams with wicked memories

New York **Times** on the Tutti Frutti necklace